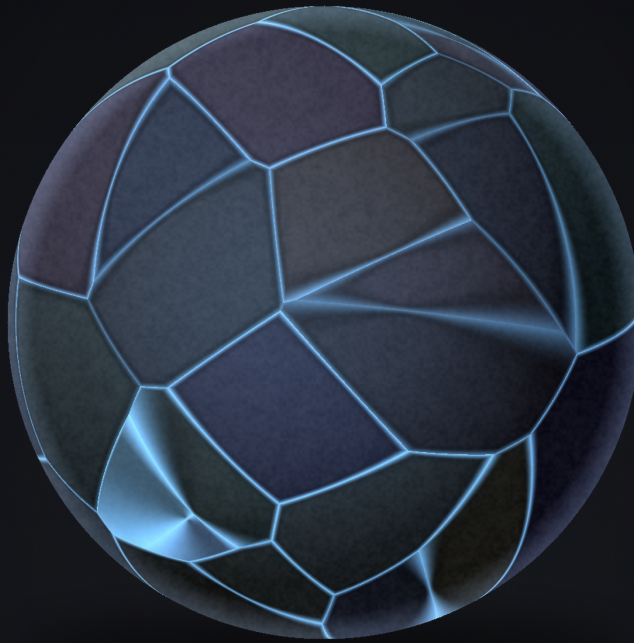


THE REPAIR WORK

A Rupture Repair Protocol



For the

UNFAITHFUL PARTNER

KEJUJIANA JOHNSON, MA, LPC, NCC, BC-TMH, CPCS

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Educational content only — not therapy and not a substitute for professional care. If you are experiencing abuse, contact the National Domestic Violence Hotline at 1-800-799-7233 (thehotline.org) or text HOME to 741741 (Crisis Text Line).

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Worksheet Appendix

These worksheets are designed to be completed alongside the book, ideally in collaboration with a licensed mental health professional. All worksheets include environment considerations – guidance about when, where, and how to complete each exercise safely.

How to Use These Worksheets

Every worksheet in this appendix includes an Environment Considerations box at the top. Please read this section before beginning any exercise. These considerations are not optional – they are part of the clinical design of the worksheet.

Betrayal trauma is a physiological event. Your nervous system does not distinguish between a worksheet prompt and an actual threat. The wrong environment, wrong timing, or wrong emotional state can cause a worksheet exercise to become retraumatizing rather than healing. The environment considerations exist to prevent that.

What "Window of Tolerance" Means

Your window of tolerance is the zone of arousal in which your nervous system can process difficult material without going into survival mode. Inside this window, you feel present, grounded, and capable of thinking clearly. Outside it – either above (flooded, panicked, overwhelmed) or below (shut down, numb, dissociated) – processing shuts down.

Before beginning any worksheet, check your current arousal level on a 0–10 scale:

0–3: You are very calm. Some worksheets that require light reflection are fine.

4–5: You are in a good zone for most worksheet work. Proceed with full awareness.

6–7: Proceed cautiously, or only with a therapist present. Skip heavy-content worksheets.

8–10: STOP. Do not begin any worksheet. Use grounding tools first. Contact your therapist.

Standard Grounding Toolkit

If you become overwhelmed during any worksheet, use these before continuing or reaching out for support:

5-4-3-2-1: Name 5 things you can see, 4 you can touch, 3 you can hear, 2 you can smell, 1 you can taste.

Vagus nerve breath: In for 4 counts, hold 4, out for 8. Repeat 3-5 times.

Physical anchor: Press feet into floor, hands on knees, feel the weight of your own body.

Verbal anchor: *"I am being triggered. I am not in danger. I am in the present. This will pass."*

Your Support Contacts

My therapist / counselor:

My crisis contact (person I trust):

Crisis line I can call:

National Crisis Line: 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline – call or text 988

Worksheet 1

Shame vs. Guilt Inventory

Purpose: Learn to distinguish between shame (I am bad) and guilt (I did something bad) so you can use shame productively rather than letting it collapse you into defensiveness or paralysis.

ENVIRONMENT CONSIDERATIONS	
TIME NEEDED	30–45 minutes
ENVIRONMENT	Private, alone. Not in your partner's presence. This worksheet asks you to be honest about your interior experience — it requires privacy to be useful.
BEFORE YOU BEGIN	Any distress level is appropriate for this worksheet — including high distress. It is designed to help you work with whatever state you are in. However, if you are in acute conflict (actively arguing), wait until the conflict has settled.
COMPLETE THIS WHEN	After reading Chapter 1 of this book. Any time you notice you are feeling flooded or defensive when your partner is triggered. When you are in therapy and your therapist asks you to do interior work.
DO NOT COMPLETE WHEN	In your partner's presence. Immediately before or during a hard conversation with your partner.
► IF YOU BECOME OVERWHELMED	This worksheet may bring up significant feelings of shame, regret, or self-criticism. If these become intense, use the breath: in for 4, hold 4, out for 8. Remind yourself that naming shame is the first step to moving through it — not away from it. Bring intense feelings to your therapist.

Part 1: What I Did (Guilt Territory)

Guilt is connected to specific behavior. Name the specific things you did — not the affair as a monolith, but the individual choices, moments, and actions.

List specific things you did that caused harm (be concrete, not abstract):

Part 2: What I'm Saying About Myself (Shame Territory)

Shame goes beyond the behavior to a verdict on your identity. What are you telling yourself about who you ARE because of what you did?

Finish these sentences honestly:

Because of what I did, I am:

Because of what I did, I deserve:

Because of what I did, I am the kind of person who:

When my partner looks at me, they see:

Part 3: Separating the Two

Now separate your specific behavior from your global self-verdict.

What I did: (*The behavior — guilt territory*)

What that makes me: (*The identity verdict — shame territory*)

What I want to say to that verdict:

Part 4: Moving From Shame to Action

Guilt motivates repair. Shame motivates hiding. Finish these sentences from the guilt side — focused on impact, not identity.

The specific harm I caused that I want to repair is:

One concrete thing I can do today to address that harm:

What my partner needs that only I can give them right now:

Date completed: _____ Brought to therapy: ____ (date)

Worksheet 2

The Full Accountability Statement

Purpose: Write a complete, undefended account of what happened — not to share with your partner, but to be honest with yourself about the full weight of what you did.

ENVIRONMENT CONSIDERATIONS	
TIME NEEDED	45–90 minutes. This is a significant piece of work. Do not rush it.
ENVIRONMENT	PRIVATE. This document is for you and your therapist — NOT for your partner unless your therapist specifically recommends sharing it. Complete alone, in a space where you will not be interrupted. Have water nearby.
BEFORE YOU BEGIN	Distress level 5 or below. This exercise requires your full honesty and your rational capacity — both of which are compromised in high arousal states. If you are currently in a flooded state, wait.
COMPLETE THIS WHEN	After reading Chapter 3 of this book. After at least one individual therapy session in which you have begun to examine why you made the choices you made.
DO NOT COMPLETE WHEN	Before you have read Chapter 3. If you are planning to share this immediately with your partner without therapeutic support. If you are currently in crisis.
▀ IF YOU BECOME OVERWHELMED	Expect this to be hard. Some discomfort is appropriate and necessary. But if you find yourself spiraling into shame collapse (not guilt, but identity-level shame), stop. Use the breath. Write "I am taking a break" and put the worksheet down. Return when calmer. Bring incomplete sections to therapy — do not force yourself through this alone.

REMINDER: This is for you — your clarity, your accountability, your growth. It is not a document to earn forgiveness. It is not a transaction.

Prompt 1: What I Did

Describe specifically what happened — not the emotional context, not the why, just what you did. Concrete. Chronological if that helps. No softening language.

Prompt 2: When I Knew

At what point did you know this was wrong? What did you tell yourself to continue past that point?

The moment I knew it was wrong:

What I told myself to keep going anyway:

Prompt 3: What My Partner Lost Without Knowing

Your partner was robbed of information, presence, and partnership they believed they had. Name what they lost:

What my partner was experiencing, trusting, and investing in while this was happening:

Prompt 4: What Was Happening In Me

Not as excuses. As understanding. What were you running from, avoiding, longing for, or escaping? Be honest. This is the section your individual therapy should be helping you with.

What I was feeling or avoiding that I used this to manage:

Prompt 5: The Harm — Without Qualification

Write a full account of the harm you caused. No "but." No "because." No "I know this doesn't excuse it, but..." Just the harm.

The harm I caused:

Prompt 6: What I Commit To

Not what you commit to getting — what you commit to doing. Focus on behavior, not outcomes.

I commit to:

Date completed: _____ Reviewed with therapist: ____ (date) DO NOT share with partner without therapeutic guidance

Worksheet 3

The Rushing Urge Log

Purpose: Track the moments when you feel the urge to rush your partner's healing, so you can identify your patterns and interrupt them before they cause re-injury.

ENVIRONMENT CONSIDERATIONS	
TIME NEEDED	5-10 minutes per entry (ongoing daily log)
ENVIRONMENT	Anywhere private. Designed for daily use — a notebook, a phone, or this page. Complete as close to the moment as possible for accuracy.
BEFORE YOU BEGIN	No special preparation needed. This is a log, not an intensive exercise.
COMPLETE THIS WHEN	After any moment in which you felt the urge to rush, minimize, or express impatience with your partner's healing — whether or not you acted on it. The log works best when completed daily, including days when no urge arose.
DO NOT COMPLETE WHEN	In front of your partner. This is your private accountability tool.
► IF YOU BECOME OVERWHELMED	If reviewing your log entries reveals a pattern that is distressing or that you don't know how to interrupt, bring the log to therapy. That is exactly what it is for.

Use this log for at least four weeks. Each entry takes 5–10 minutes. Over time, patterns will emerge — specific triggers, times of day, emotional states — that you can then work on in therapy.

Entry 1

Date/Time: _____ My distress level right now (0–10): _____

What triggered the urge to rush:

What I felt in my body:

What I did (or did not do):

If I rushed: what was the impact I noticed on my partner?

If I stayed: what made that possible?

Entry 2

Date/Time: _____ My distress level right now (0–10): _____

What triggered the urge to rush:

What I felt in my body:

What I did (or did not do):

If I rushed: what was the impact I noticed on my partner?

If I stayed: what made that possible?

Entry 3

Date/Time: _____ My distress level right now (0-10): _____

What triggered the urge to rush:

What I felt in my body:

What I did (or did not do):

If I rushed: what was the impact I noticed on my partner?

If I stayed: what made that possible?

Monthly Pattern Review

At the end of each month, review your entries and answer:

The situations that most reliably trigger the urge to rush:

The emotional state I'm usually in when the urge is strongest:

What I notice about the times I successfully did NOT rush:

One pattern I want to work on with my therapist:

Worksheet 4

Consistency Weekly Check-In

Purpose: A weekly self-accountability review to ensure that your behavior aligns with your intentions – and to catch drift before it becomes a pattern.

ENVIRONMENT CONSIDERATIONS	
TIME NEEDED	15–20 minutes (weekly)
ENVIRONMENT	Private, ideally at a consistent time each week (Sunday evening works well for many people). Bring this to your individual therapy session weekly.
BEFORE YOU BEGIN	This is a low-intensity reflective exercise. Any calm moment is appropriate.
COMPLETE THIS WHEN	Once per week, consistently, on a day and time you set in advance.
DO NOT COMPLETE WHEN	This worksheet has minimal contraindications. If you are in acute crisis, wait until you have stabilized. Otherwise, complete it even in hard weeks – especially in hard weeks.
► IF YOU BECOME OVERWHELMED	This worksheet may surface uncomfortable truths about your consistency. That discomfort is the point. Sit with it. Bring the specific hard truths to therapy rather than letting them stay buried.

Complete this check-in every week for at least three months. Bring it to your individual therapy sessions – your therapist needs to know what is actually happening, not a summary.

Week of: _____

Section 1: Transparency

How fully transparent was I this week? Hidden things [1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10] Fully open

Specific things I was transparent about that I could have hidden:

Anything I chose to omit or not mention this week (and why):

Section 2: Presence During Triggers

If your partner was triggered this week, describe what happened.

How many times was my partner triggered this week (approximate):

How I responded:

What I did well:

Where I slipped (rushed, minimized, went defensive, withdrew):

How I repaired it (if applicable):

Section 3: Their Healing vs. My Comfort

One thing I did this week that was genuinely for their healing:

One moment when I prioritized my comfort over their needs:

Section 4: My Interior Work

What I'm learning in individual therapy right now:

A pattern I recognized in myself this week:

Something that's getting clearer about why I did what I did:

Section 5: Honest Rating

Overall consistency this week: Off track [1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10] On track

The most honest thing I can say about how I'm doing this work right now:

What I want to do differently next week:

— — — *Reproduce this page for weekly use* — — —

Worksheet 5

My Individual Therapy Work Tracker

Purpose: Track what you are learning about yourself in individual therapy so the work compounds over time and doesn't get lost between sessions.

ENVIRONMENT CONSIDERATIONS	
TIME NEEDED	10–15 minutes (between therapy sessions)
ENVIRONMENT	Private. Complete this between sessions — either right after a session (while it is fresh) or the day before your next session (to prepare).
BEFORE YOU BEGIN	No special preparation. This is a tracking and reflection tool, not an intensive exercise.
COMPLETE THIS WHEN	Weekly, between individual therapy sessions. Also useful before couples therapy sessions to connect what you are learning individually to what is happening relationally.
DO NOT COMPLETE WHEN	This worksheet has no contraindications.
► IF YOU BECOME OVERWHELMED	If a therapy insight feels too large to track on paper, that's okay — bring it verbally to your next session. The tracker is a support tool, not a requirement.

This tracker is designed to be used across the full arc of your individual work. It helps you see growth over time and ensures that insights don't evaporate between sessions.

Session date: _____ Session number: _____

After the Session

The most important thing that came up in today's session:

Something I said or heard today that I want to sit with:

A pattern or belief about myself I'm beginning to understand:

Something I was honest about today that was hard to say:

Something I want to say next time that I didn't say today:

What I'm Learning About Why

The most important work in individual therapy is understanding the interior landscape that made the affair feel like an available option. Track that understanding here.

What I'm beginning to understand about why I did this:

A pattern from my history or family that shows up in this:

Something I used the affair to avoid feeling or facing:

What's Changing

A belief I held that my therapy work is shifting:

A behavior I am doing differently because of this work:

How close I am to genuinely understanding why I did this: No understanding [1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10] Full clarity

Preparing for Next Session

The most important thing I want to bring to my next session:

A question I want to ask my therapist:

What I want them to know is happening at home right now:

Next session date: _____

Worksheet 6

The Honesty Audit: Why Am I Still Here?

Purpose: Determine whether you are staying in this relationship because you genuinely want it – or because staying is easier, safer, or less costly than leaving. You cannot do the work of repair if you have not answered this question honestly. Your partner deserves someone who chose them. This worksheet asks whether you have.

Your Action	Their Physiological Response
You sigh or roll your eyes	Their amygdala registers disdain. Cortisol spikes. Nervous system goes to high alert. The threat has expanded from "the affair" to "the person I love is dismissing my pain."
You say "I thought we were past this"	Their brain hears: "Your pain is an inconvenience. Your timeline is wrong. You are failing at healing." The shame they already carry deepens. Anger rises to cover it.
You say "You are choosing to be unhappy"	Their brain hears: "Your pain is your fault. You are not trying hard enough." The injustice of being blamed for the aftermath of your actions ignites a fury that is physiological, not just emotional.
You say "What more do you want?"	Their brain hears: "I have done enough. You are asking for too much." Their trust shatters again. Their body goes into freeze or fight.
You withdraw or go silent	Their hypervigilant nervous system reads your silence as evidence of continued deception. The threat response activates. They feel more alone than they did before they told you they were struggling.

Part 1: Why You Are Still Here — The Honest List

Check only the lines that have genuine evidence behind them — not fear, not hope. Evidence.

☐ I am still here because I am afraid to be alone.

- ☐ I am still here because of what people would say — family, church, community, colleagues.
- ☐ I am still here because of logistics — money, the house, the children's schedules, the shared life.
- ☐ I am still here because leaving feels like giving up, and I don't like to give up.
- ☐ I am still here because my partner has not left, and I am following their lead.
- ☐ I am still here because I am waiting to see if I feel something.
- ☐ I am still here because I want this relationship — and my actions in the past weeks reflect a person who wants it.

Part 2: Did You Ask For Forgiveness?

Not: performed remorse when caught. Not: cried. Not: said 'I'm sorry.' Did you say the words — in a way that named what you did, acknowledged the harm, and asked for grace?

Did you ever ask your partner directly for forgiveness? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not yet

If yes — write what you said, and when:

Did the apology end with a request — or pivot to what you needed? ☐ Ended clean ☐ Pivoted

Has the apology been repeated — or issued once, to end the conversation? ☐ Repeated ☐ Once

Part 3: Did You Claim This Relationship?

Staying is not the same as choosing. The question is whether your partner has ever heard you say, in words, that you want them.

Have you said, out loud, that you want this relationship? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes — write the words you used, and what prompted them:

Were those words spontaneous — or said under pressure, in a crisis moment? ☐ Spontaneous ☐ Under pressure

Have you said it to anyone besides your partner — therapist, friend, family member? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Have your daily actions looked like someone protecting something they chose? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Some days

Part 4: What You Are Actually Giving Them

Based on your answers: the reason you are staying is mostly:

☐ Fear / avoidance ☐ External pressure ☐ Genuine choice ☐ Still unclear

The apology you gave was: ☐ Real and complete ☐ Partial ☐ Has not happened yet

The claim you made on this relationship was: ☐ Real and repeated ☐ Said once under pressure ☐ Has not happened yet

What I have been giving my partner instead of a clear choice:

What I owe them — in words, out loud — that I have not said yet:

What This Means for You

If your answers point toward genuine choice: the foundation is real. Return to the roadmap in Chapter Seven and keep building.

If your answers point toward fear, logistics, or external pressure: you have not yet given your partner what they actually need — someone who chose them. Presence without choice is not repair. It is waiting. And your partner, who is working as hard as they can to decide whether to trust you again, deserves to know whether there is actually something here to rebuild toward.

The most important thing you can do right now is not perform accountability. It is decide. And then say so — out loud, to them, in words that do not leave room for interpretation.

Date completed: _____ Reviewed in therapy: ____ (date)

A Letter to Yourself

Before you reach the note for your partner, there is one more thing.

You have read this entire book. Whether you came to it with genuine willingness or because you were handed it and had no better option — you stayed in it. You read the parts that were hard to read. You sat with the scenes that were hard to sit in. You made it to the last chapter.

That is not nothing. Do not let it be nothing.

The exercise below is not required. It is an invitation. Sit with it when you are ready — not right now if right now is not the right time. But do not skip past it entirely.

Write a letter to yourself. Not to who you were before. Not to who you hope to become. To who you are right now — in this moment, having read what you read, having sat in what you sat in.

Write about what you know now that you did not know when you started. Write about what is still unclear. Write about the thing in Chapter __ that you wanted to argue with — and whether you still want to argue with it.

Write about what you owe yourself. Not what you owe your partner, not what you owe the relationship — what you owe yourself, as a person who is choosing to become different.

Write about what you are afraid of.

Write about what you are going to do differently tomorrow.

There is no wrong way to write this letter. There is only the truth or the management of the truth. Write the truth.

Keep this letter somewhere you will find it again — in six months, in a year. Read it then and see who you were on the day you finished this book, and who you have become since.

That distance — between who you were when you wrote it and who you are when you read it again — is the measure of the work.

Do the work.

A Note on Professional Support

This book was written to be a companion to your therapeutic work — not a substitute for it. The patterns that led to the affair, the shame dynamics, the interior landscape that made those choices feel available: understanding these things fully requires the sustained,

boundaried presence of a skilled individual therapist. A book cannot do that work. It can only point you toward it.

If you are not currently in individual therapy, please begin. Not because your partner asked you to — because you owe it to yourself and to anyone you will ever love to understand what happened inside you and why. That understanding is the foundation of genuine non-repetition.

If you are experiencing suicidal thoughts, a mental health crisis, or thoughts of harming yourself or others, please reach out immediately. The 988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline is available 24/7 by calling or texting 988. You do not have to be alone in this.

Resources for Support

The following resources support the interior work described in this book. Many are designed for the unfaithful partner specifically — for the work of understanding why, building accountability, and becoming someone different.

Crisis and Immediate Support

988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline

Call or text 988 — available 24/7 for anyone in emotional distress or crisis.

Crisis Text Line

Text HOME to 741741 — free, confidential 24/7 text-based crisis support.

National Domestic Violence Hotline

1-800-799-7233 or text START to 88788 — if infidelity has occurred in the context of coercive control, this resource offers specialized support.

Finding a Therapist

Psychology Today Therapist Directory

psychologytoday.com/us/therapists — Search by specialty, insurance, and location. Filter for "infidelity," "betrayal trauma," or "emotionally focused therapy."

ICEEFT (International Centre for Excellence in EFT)

iceeft.com — Directory of certified EFT therapists. EFT (Emotionally Focused Therapy) has the strongest research base for couples recovering from infidelity.

NBCC Counselor Find

counselorfind.com — Directory of National Board Certified Counselors by location and specialty.

Accountability and Recovery Support

SA — Sexaholics Anonymous

sa.org — 12-step fellowship for those whose infidelity involves compulsive sexual behavior. Free meetings, worldwide.

AASAT — Association for the Treatment of Sexual Addiction and Compulsivity

sexhelp.com — Find a CSAT (Certified Sex Addiction Therapist) for specialized individual work.

Books That May Help

Brené Brown, *Daring Greatly* (2012)

Robert Weiss, *Out of the Doghouse* (2017)

Shirley Glass, *Not "Just Friends"* (2003)

Peter Scanzero, *Emotionally Healthy Spirituality* (2006)

Terry Real, *Us: Getting Past You and Me to Build a More Loving Relationship* (2022)

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This book would not exist without the clients who trusted me with their most fractured moments. They are not in these pages by name, but they are in every line. What I know about betrayal trauma I learned from them — from watching them survive what felt unsurvivable, and from the privilege of sitting with them in the darkest rooms until the light came back.

To the clinicians who came before — the researchers, the theorists, the practitioners who built the frameworks I have stood on — I am grateful. The work of Sue Johnson, John Gottman, Bessel van der Kolk, Peter Levine, and Brené Brown is woven into the fabric of this text, even where their names do not appear.

To the partner who handed this book across a table, a bed, or a kitchen counter: that act of hope is extraordinary. You deserved better than what you got. I hope this book helps.

With gratitude,

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About the Author

Kejuiana Johnson, MA, LPC, NCC, BC-TMH, CPCS

She holds active clinical licenses in Georgia, Florida, Idaho, and Texas, and brings to her practice a deep commitment to treating the whole person: nervous system and story, body and belief, the wound and the way through. Her specialized focus includes betrayal trauma, relationship repair, attachment injuries, and the neuroscience of healing — the intersection where clinical rigor meets the lived human experience.

As the creator of CounselorReady™, a professional development platform for licensed clinicians, and PassReady Prep™, a clinical examination preparation resource, Kejuiana has built a career around the conviction that clarity is a form of care. The same directness she brings to her writing is what her clients describe in her practice: she does not soften what needs to be said, and she does not leave people alone in the hard rooms.

She is a Board Certified-TeleMental Health provider (BC-TMH), a National Certified Counselor (NCC), and a Certified Professional Counselor Supervisor (CPCS), offering clinical supervision to provisionally licensed counselors in pursuit of full licensure.

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To connect with Kejuiana's professional resources, CE courses for licensed counselors, or to inquire about clinical supervision, visit:

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The Repair Work

The Repair Work: For the Betrayed

The Repair Work: For the Unfaithful Partner

A two-book set for couples navigating the aftermath of infidelity — one volume for each person in the room.

The Bridging the Gap Series

Understanding Intimacy — Book One

The Power of Talk — Book Two

A couples education series exploring the science and practice of lasting intimacy, communication, and repair.

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Bridging Two Worlds — Intercultural couples and the work of loving across difference

Married to the Mission — A relationship guide for military spouses

Beyond His, Hers, and Them — A twelve-chapter relationship audit for queer partnerships

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